

profound knowledge of the contemplative tradition with good sense and human sensitivity. Already a best-selling religious book in England, its publication in America with a foreword by Henri J. M. Nouwen should expand the range of grateful readers a great deal.

The author, Rector of St. Matthew's Church, Bethnal Green, carefully sets the stage for spiritual direction and counsel. After reflection on the place of spirituality in the present climate he traces the history of spiritual direction in the Christian tradition, carefully distinguishes it from counseling and therapy, lays down some guidelines for the practice of the life of prayer, and offers some thoughts concerning spiritual direction and social change. Happily, while admitting that spirituality has sometimes led to avoidance of social responsibility, he presents a strong case on the other side. His own ministry attests to the validity of his case.

This splendid book should receive a ready reception among persons in the catholic tradition—Roman Catholics, Anglicans or Episcopalians, and Orthodox. A growing number of Protestants is also manifesting a keen interest in spirituality and even spiritual formation. Whether persons on the voluntarist end of the voluntarist-intentional end of the spectrum, such as Baptists, can take it with equal seriousness is improbable. The weight of authority and the idea of obedience to a human director loom

too large here for many of them to consider any immediate adoption of this approach to spirituality. Yet all can learn and adapt. The challenge for voluntarists is how to obtain the same desired end—the vision of God—by some alternate route. Meantime, they can gain much from Kenneth Leech's balanced and wise discussion.

E. Glenn Hinson



Joachim of Fiore and the Prophetic Future, by Majorie Reeves. New York: Harper & Row, 1977. 212 pp. No price given.

The debt of such groups as the spiritual Franciscans to Joachim of Fiore (c. 1135-1202), a one time Cistercian who eventually (in 1196) founded his own order, is well known. Less widely known is his influence on political theorists of the thirteenth and fourteenth centuries and of the Renaissance, on Catholic and Protestant visionaries during and after the Reformation, and on philosophers or literary figures of the modern era such as Lessing, Comte, W. B. Yeats, and Jung. Ms. Reeves, of course, has not tried to establish direct dependency everywhere, but her erudite research creates a powerful cumulative impression that the modern era owes much to Joachim's conviction that prophetic expectations would be fulfilled in history.

The title of this brilliant study is slightly misleading, for it is less an

exposition of the thought of Joachim than a careful sketch of his legacy. Actually only one chapter is devoted to Joachim's system. The major part of the work focuses on his heirs from the thirteenth to the seventeenth century.

Ms. Reeves is deserving of the highest praise for her historiography. She has threaded through a maze of literature in several languages, summarizing often abstruse ideas with precision. She has avoided the temptation to overstate the case for Joachimite influence and allowed the evidence to establish her thesis. Her efforts should stimulate further probing into the background of contemporary socio-economic and political thought.

E. Glenn Hinson



Lectures on Philosophical Theology, by Immanuel Kant. Tr. by Allen W. Wood and Gertrude M. Clark. Ithaca: Cornell University Press, 1978. 175 pp. \$12.50.

We are extremely fortunate to have this translation of Kant's writing on philosophical theology. These texts have never been available in English, and this translation will cause a rethinking of Kant's theology in this country. There are numerous discussions herein of topics Kant did not treat elsewhere: the nature and attributes of God, His relation to the world, God's causality, creation and

providence. Those whose work with Kant has centered on his *Critiques* will be surprised at how close some of his ideas were to orthodoxy on these subjects.

There is a considerable textual history to these texts, but Wood's introduction convinces us of their authenticity. There is a terseness, a literary neatness, perhaps even logical elegance, to these pages that contrast so completely to the stiffer, more technical and sententious prose of the *Critiques*. The translation is excellent, straightforward, and the translators insist they did not attempt to improve on Kant's style. Wood's introduction and notes help to locate and indentify the allusions.

We usually think of Kant's moralism as the guide to understanding his theology. Yet when we turn to these pages, we are impressed at how thoroughly he has worked out the far theological reaches of his whole philosophy. There is frequent remarkable agreement between Kant and orthodoxy on providence, God's immutability, his will (the last two not to be set against each other), his rejection and refutation of atheism, etc. His views of the ontological argument are all too famous. What he says here does not contradict what he says in the first *Critique*. However, there is more historical detail here, for he praises Anselm's form of the argument as "the ground of every possible theology" while he criticizes Descartes' form of the argument. The historical detail does